

LESSON - 2



THE FOOLISH SON-IN-LAW

Session - 1

I

PRE-READING

■ Socialisation :

Students, do you know there are many stories about foolish son-in-laws ? These stories are there in every language. Can anyone of you tell us such a story ?



Do you want to listen to such a story ? (Teacher tells the following story)

There was a village quack (a fake or false practitioner). He also trained his son to be a quack. One day the father-in-law of his son had a fever. He, therefore, sent his son to treat his father-in-law. When his son was about to leave, he gave him some advice.



“Listen, son. Common sense will make you a great doctor. Simple common sense. Then he gave him an example from his experience. “Once I went to treat a patient. I saw banana peels (banana skin) under his cot. Then testing his pulse (feeling) I said,” You must have taken banana. That is why you have a bad cold. The patient and his father were surprised. How could I tell from his pulse that he had eaten banana. In this way using my common sense, I became a very famous doctor. Therefore, son, use your common sense.”

The son went to his father-in-law. He saw him lying on a cot. Under the cot, a cat was sleeping. Now he wanted to use his common sense like his father

to become famous. He took the pulse of his father-in-law for sometime, and pretended to think. Then he said "Father-in-law, you must have eaten a cat, which is why you are running a high temperature.

Do you want to read a similar story ?
Here is one for you.



II

WHILE-READING

Text

SGP-1

- Read paragraph - 1 silently and answer the questions that follow.
- 1. A son-in-law, after his marriage, was planning to visit his father-in-law's house for the first time. A man from his village gave him the advice, "Use big and high sounding words in your father-in-law's house. Always sit on a high place. First say 'No' to any food given to you."
- **Comprehension Questions :**
 1. Who are there in this part of the story?
 2. What was the son-in-law's plan?
 3. Who advised him about some dos and don'ts at his in-law's house?
 4. Make a list of all the advice.

Session - 2

SGP-2

- Read paragraphs 2 - 3 silently and answer the questions that follow.
- 2. He, therefore, used very long and high sounding words. He told his mother-in-law, "You are the sweetest, kindest, greatest and gentlest lady." The mother-in-law was very much pleased to hear this. She praised her son-in-law in front of her neighbours for using high sounding words and calling her the kindest and greatest lady.

3. Following strictly the second advice, the son-in-law did not sit on a chair. He preferred to sit over paddy sacks piled high. Similarly when any food was given to him, he said, "No". One night his mother-in-law prepared delicious rice-pudding (Khiri) for him. When he was served this, he said, "No". Therefore, he was not given rice-pudding. But two or three drops of rice-pudding fell on his plate. When he tasted it, he wanted to have more of it. Thinking it would be impolite, he did not ask for it. But he wanted somehow to eat the rice-pudding. He carefully watched his mother-in-law. She put the rice pudding on a pot and placed it on sikka (a high place).

● **Comprehension Questions :**

1. What type of words did he use in speaking ?
2. What did he tell his mother-in-law ?
3. Was she happy ?
4. What did she do ?
5. Where did the son-in-law sit? Does the sight make others laugh ?
6. What did he say when the rice pudding was served ?
7. Did he want to eat the pudding ?
8. Where was the pudding pot kept ?
9. Could he eat it ?

Session - 3

SGP-3

- Read paragraphs 4 - 5 silently and answer the questions that follow.
4. At the dead of night, he tried to get the pudding from the pot. But unfortunately, it fell on his head. His whole body was smeared with rice pudding like gum. "What to do now ?" he thought to himself. He saw freshly plucked cotton spread on a mat to dry. He slept on it and turned two to three times left and right. Then he looked like a lamb. "What to do now?" he thought to himself. So he went to the cow-shed where some lambs lived. He stayed there throughout the night like a lamb.

5. In the morning the in-laws searched for their son-in-law and found him in the cow-shed. Everyone, except the mother-in-law, thought him to be foolish. But the mother-in-law so pleaded, "My son-in-law is as simple and as innocent as a lamb". This made the father-in-law very angry. He was also very angry for other reasons. His wife took too much care of her foolish son-in-law. She gave him good food but neglected her husband. The son-in-law, living in comfort, was not willing to go home.

● **Comprehension Questions :**

1. What happened when the son-in-law tried to get the pot of pudding ?
2. What did he look like when he turned on cotton ?
3. What are the two funny sights? Do they make you laugh ?
4. Where did the in-laws find him in the morning ?
5. Who thought him to be foolish ?
6. Why was the father-in-law angry ?

Will the son-in-law stay here always ?

SGP-4

- Read paragraph - 6 silently and answer the questions that follow.
6. The father-in-law, therefore, planned how to drive him out. They had a lemon plant full of green lemons. One day he said to his son-in-law "Kind son, you have seen our lemon tree. The lemons are stolen by thieves at night. I'll be happy if you can watch the plant tonight and catch the thief." He also gave his son-in-law a club. In the darkness of night, the son -in-law was waiting for the thieves to come. The father-in-law wished to take water rice and asked his wife to bring a fresh lemon from the lemon plant. When the mother-in-law was plucking a lemon, the son-in-law thrashed her with the club thinking her to be a thief. Coming to know that he had beaten his mother-in-law, he felt so ashamed that he left for his home that night itself. The father-in-law heaved a great sigh of relief.

● Comprehension Questions :

1. Why was not the son-in-law willing to go home ?
2. Who went to bring lemon from the garden ?
3. Why did he beat his mother-in-law ?
4. What made him leave for his home ?
5. Is there anything funny in this part ?
6. Was his father-in-law happy ? Which expression (words) in the text tells you so ?

Session - 4

III

POST-READING

1 Visual Memory Development Technique (VMDT) :

Whole Text : son- in-law sat on the sack of paddy - said 'No' to the mother-in-law.

Part : served first - tried to get the pudding-looked like a lamb - thrashed the mother-in-law.

2 Comprehension Activities :

(a) Choose the right answer from the options.

1. The son-in-law was not advised to _____.
 - (a) use big and high sounding words.
 - (b) sit on a high place.
 - (c) watch the garden.
 - (d) say 'no' to any food given to him first.
2. The son-in-law thought it would be _____ to ask for pudding.
 - (a) impossible
 - (b) important
 - (c) impolite
 - (d) impatient

3. Everyone, except _____ thought him to be foolish.
(a) the father-in-law
(b) the mother-in-law
(c) the brother-in-law
(d) the sister-in-law
4. The father-in-law planned to drive out the son-in-law because
(a) he sat on a high place.
(b) he beat his wife.
(c) he ate all the rice pudding.
(d) his wife took much care of her son-in-law neglecting him.

(b) Match the part number under 'A' with their content in 'B'.

A

Part-1

Part-2

Part-3

Part-4

B

- leaves the in-law's house

- suffers for foolishness

- Son-in-law plans his visit

- follows the advice

Session - 5

3 Listening :

Listen to your teacher and fill in the gaps.

“Kind son, you have seen our lemon _____. The lemons are stolen by thieves at _____. I'll be _____ if you can _____ the plant tonight and catch the _____.” He also gave his son-in-law a _____. In the _____ the son-in-law was _____ for the thieves to _____.

4 Speaking :

Chain-drill : A fool gets the truth too late
: We laugh at the fool or at his foolishness.

Dialogue

Mother-in-law : Son, would you like to have some pudding ? I've prepared it for you.

Son-in-law : No, thanks.

Session - 6

5 Vocabulary :

- (a) Some words in English are made by joining 'in-law' after them. For example ,

Father-in-law

Make 5 more words in this way.

- (b) Read the following part of your lesson.

His whole body was smeared by rice pudding like gum . He slept on it (fresh plucked cotton) and turned two three times left and right. Then he looked like a lamb.

The underlined sentence tells that the son-in-law looked like a lamb but he was not a lamb. We use 'look like ' to say something or someone looks like something or someone else different.

Rewrite the sentences using 'look like'.

- (i) At sunset or morning the sun (look like) a big ball.

(ii) The girl (look like) a princess in her fancy dress.

_____.

(iii) Clouds in sky sometimes (look like) elephants.

_____.

(iv) The clear blue sky (look like) an umbrella.

_____.

(v) Her face (look like) a moon.

_____.

Session - 7

6 Usage :

- (a) **‘Son-in-law’ is a long word. The head word is son. When we change son-in-law into plural, it becomes ‘sons-in-law’.**

Change the following words into plural.

singular (one)

Plural (many)

son-in-law

sons-in-law

daughter-in-law

father-in-law

mother-in-law

brother-in-law

sister-in-law

b. Match the word in A with word in B. Words in B are opposite in meaning . Write the serial numbers of words in the boxes. One is done for you.

A

1. high
2. pleased
3. polite
4. careful
5. fortunate
6. fresh
7. dry
8. foolish
9. innocent
10. comfort
11. willing
12. kind

B

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------------|
| ☐ | wet |
| ☐ | careless |
| ☐ | clever |
| ☐ | rotten |
| ☐ | guilty |
| ☐ | impolite |
| ☐ | displeased |
| ☒ | low |
| ☐ | unfortunate |
| ☐ | cruel |
| ☐ | discomfort |
| ☐ | unwilling |

Session - 8

7 Writing :

(i) Write answers to the following questions.

(i) What is the story about ?

(ii) Who advised him what to do and what not to do ?

(iii) Why did he want to have pudding ? (p-3)

(iv) Where was the pudding kept ? (p-3)

(v) What happened when he tried to get the pudding ? (p-4)

(vi) Why was the father-in-law angry ? (p-5)

(vii) Who planned a trick to drive him out ? (p-6)

(viii) Why did he leave the in-law's house ?

Session - 9

(ii) Stated below what the father-in-law said to his friend after his son-in-law had left. Read what he said and fill in the gaps consulting the story.

“Do you know how I drove away the son-in-law? He was _____. But my wife thought him to be _____. She gave her _____ food every day. And she neglected me. So, I thought of a _____. I asked my son-in-law to

_____ the _____ tree. I gave him a _____ to beat the _____. It was night. I asked my _____ to bring a _____. When she plucked a _____ the son-in-law _____ her. He felt ashamed coming to know that he had _____ his mother-in-law. Out of shame he _____ my home. I breathed _____.”

8 Mental Talk :

“A fool gets the truth too late.”

9 Let us Think :

Do we laugh at the fool or his foolishness ?

FOLLOW-UP LESSON

BAMBOO CURRY

Session - 1

I

PRE-READING

- You have read the Odia folk- tale “The Foolish Son-in-Law”. In other languages, there are similar stories. Let us read a similar Santal folk-tale “Bamboo Curry”.

II

WHILE-READING

TEXT

SGP - 1

- Read paragraphs 1 - 2 silently and answer the questions that follow.

1. Once a foolish Santal son-in-law went to his in-law's place. His mother-in-law cooked delicious dishes for her son-in-law. One of the dishes was a curry made out of bamboo shoot. The son-in-law liked it very much and asked his mother-in-law, "Mother, the curry is extremely delicious. What is the curry made from?" Instead of answering his question, she pointed at the bamboo door. The son-in-law asked, "Is it from bamboo?" Yes son, the curry is made from bamboo and is, therefore, called "Bamboo Curry".



2. Next day, the son-in-law was about to leave for his home. The bamboo curry came to his mind. He thought of cooking bamboo curry at home. But they did not have bamboo. So he carried home the bamboo door of his in-laws' house.



● **Comprehension Questions :**

1. Who went to his father-in-law's house ?
2. What curry did his ?
3. Did he like it ?
4. Why did he carry ?



Session - 2

SGP - 2

- Read paragraphs 3 - 4 silently and answer the questions that follow.
3. Reaching home, he asked his wife to prepare bamboo curry. He helped his wife in chopping the dry bamboo sticks. But the dry bamboo pieces did not get boiled. The pieces remained as hard and stiff as before. He asked his wife to put more water and boil.
 4. That evening his in-laws came to their son-in-law's house. The son-in-law offered them the bamboo curry. The in-laws laughed at their foolish son-in-law. They told him, "The bamboo curry is made from soft bamboo shoot and not from dry bamboo pieces".

● **Comprehension Questions :**

1. Who did he ask ?
2. How did he help..... ?
3. When the bamboo did not boil what did he ask his wife to do ?
4. Who came ?
5. Where from the ?

III

POST-READING

1 Writing :

(a) Answer the following questions.

(i) What is this story about ?

(ii) What curry did the mother-in-law prepare ?

(iii) Is the son-in-law foolish ? Why ?

Yes, the _____ because _____
He made _____ out of dry bamboo .

WORD NOTE

(The words / phrases have been defined mostly on contextual meanings.)

ashamed - feeling shame, ଲଜିତ ହେଲେ

bamboo curry - a kind of dish (food) made out of young bamboo plants. ବାଉଁଶ ଗଜା ତରକାରୀ

bamboo shoot- new-young bamboo plants- ବାଉଁଶ ଗଜା

chopping- cutting into small pieces, ଖଣ୍ଡ ଖଣ୍ଡ କରି କାଟିବା

delicious- tasty (food) ସ୍ବାଦିଷ୍ଟ, ସୁସ୍ବାଦୁ

dishes- food items, curry ତରକାରୀ, ସ୍ବାଦିଷ୍ଟ ବ୍ୟଞ୍ଜନ

folk-tale- popular story of a community, କଥୁତ ଗଳ୍ପ

gentlest- very kind (behaviour) ଅତ୍ୟନ୍ତ ନମ୍ର ବା କୋମଳ ଭାବେ

heaved a great sign of relief- feel relieved, ଆଶ୍ୱସ୍ତ ହେଲେ

high sounding words- difficult words, କଠିନ ବା ବଡ଼ ବଡ଼ ଶବ୍ଦ

impolite- not good behaviour, rude, ଭଲ ବ୍ୟବହାର ନୁହେଁ

lamb- young sheep, ମେଣ୍ଟାଛୁଆ

offered- gave, served, ଦେଲେ (ଖାଦ୍ୟ) ପରିବେଷଣ କଲେ

piled high - kept (things) in a heap- ଗଦା, ସ୍ତୁପ

plucking- collecting (from a tree) ଚୋଳିବା

pointed - showed hand towards (bamboo door) ହାତ ଦେଖାଇ ନିର୍ଦ୍ଦେଶିତ କଲେ

preferred - chose, ପସନ୍ଦ କଲେ ବା ଆଗ୍ରହ ଦେଖାଇଲେ

quack - a self claimed ignorant practitioner, ଶଠ ବଇଦ/ଠକ ବଇଦ

smeared- spread something (substance) on body ବୋଳି ହୋଇଗଲା, ଲାଗିଗଲା

stiff - hard, କଠିନ

thought of - got an idea, ଗୋଟାଏ ଉପାୟ ଚିନ୍ତା କଲେ

thrashed- beat, ମାଡ଼ଦେଲେ, ପିଟିଲେ